

EMBA 2027**Course: Sustainability Strategy****Professor: Florian Hoos (IMD Lausanne, Switzerland)****Dates: April 24-25, 2026****Track: Brussels**

Managerial Knowledge (MK)*		Managerial Skills (MS)			Managerial Mindsets (MM)	
MK1	MK2	MS1	MS2	MS3	MM1	MM2
Mastering core aspects of business knowledge.	Evaluating the main trends.	Working effectively, efficiently, and collaboratively with others.	Building and leading teams.	Strategic vision.	Expanding the range of thinking patterns.	Embracing and leveraging ERS.
High	High	Intermediate	Low	High	High	High

1. Presentation/overview

This course introduces the concept for environmental, social, and governance management that protects and creates firm value. We will look into different conceptualizations of sustainability and how it developed from a hot topic to a topic that is facing significant backlash in some countries and industries. We will also tackle mandatory sustainability reporting which just started in Europe and is spreading around the world. This will help us to understand the Dos and Don'ts of measuring and communicating social and environmental risks and opportunities.

Based on concrete examples, you will learn how corporations develop strong sustainability risk management strategies, but also how new innovative business models of corporates and new entrepreneurial heroes manage to make profit and have a positive social and environmental impact. By looking at these concrete examples, and some trends that are important for doing business in the future, you will explore how sustainability is a source of company resilience, innovation, and in some cases of direct customer value creation. The goal of the course is not to make every company include sustainability into strategy, but to enable you to assess to what extent, and which dimensions of sustainability are important for your company to protect and create firm value in the future.

2. Intended learning outcomes

After having taken the course, participants should be able to:

- Master different sustainability concepts.
- Understand the challenge of measuring and managing sustainability impacts.
- Master the upcoming agenda of sustainability management and reporting.
- Be able to apply a sustainability mindset to your working reality.
- Use sustainability dimensions to develop successful strategies.

3. Content (list of topics)

Part 1. Introduction to sustainability as a source of risk management and value creation.

Part 2. Including sustainability in strategy: Practical examples and major concepts.

Part 3. Sustainability opportunities

Part 4. Measuring and managing sustainability impacts.

4. Detailed programme

Day 1

In the morning session, we will look at different understandings of sustainability, from Corporate Social Responsibility to current sustainability champions. We will also look at major trends that should encourage businesses to take environmental, social and governance dimensions at the heart of their strategy. In the afternoon session, we focus on implementing sustainability strategy in the daily business of your company and tackle the emerging topics around sustainability management.

Day 2

In the morning session of our second day, we will continue tackling the challenges of managing and reporting social and environmental value with a stronger focus on innovation. In the afternoon session of our second day, we will work on different business models that create environmental and social value, and what sets them apart from traditional business models. Finally, we will discuss emerging trends and challenges in the field of sustainability.

5. Pre-Course preparation and readings

Required Pre-Readings:

The following cases are mandatory readings to be able to participate during our sessions. Please make sure that you have read the cases **before** class.

 Case Studies (*posted as PDF*)

Hoos and Chowdhury (forthcoming). California Dreaming: VW's sustainability move into the electric camper van era. IMD-7-2582

Hoos, Selvaraj, Doddihal, and Damyanov (2025). Paathya: IHCL's fast track to structured sustainability. IMD-7-2648

Hoos, Derchi, and Keller-Birrer (2024). Inspiring sustainability in sports: Carbon budgeting at the International Olympic Committee. IMD-7-2512.

Hoos & Keller-Birrer (2024). Ragn-Sells: From company in crisis to circular sustainability champion. IMD-7-2567

Academic bibliography (optional background readings):

1. Carballo, R., Hoos, F., Neri-Castracane, G. & Ratti, S. (forthcoming). The exemption illusion: Why European SMEs still need sustainability data post-Omnibus. *The European Business Review*.
2. Ratti, S., Barge, F., Hoos, F., Hugard, F. Campen, D. & Schmedders, K. (2026). The good, the bad, and the ugly: What big energy and utilities players tell us about the new sustainability reporting regime. I by IMD (online).
3. Edinger-Schons, L., Stroehle, J. C., Gümüşay, A. A., Berg, F., Besharov, M., Busch, T., Etzion, D., Harji, K., Hsieh, N.-H., King, A. A., Mayer, C., Michelon, G., Rasche, A., Reinecke, J., Hoos, F. (2025). Monetary Impact Valuation for Sustainable Business. *Nature Sustainability* 8: 1102-1104.
4. Goerzen, A., van Assche, A., Zhan, J. X., & Zhang, L. (2025). From the editors: Global sustainability reporting standards and the future of international business. In *Journal of International Business Policy* 8 (2): 125–136.
5. Matsumura, E. M., Prakash, R., & Vera-Muñoz, S. C. (2024). Climate-risk materiality and firm risk. *Review of Accounting Studies* 29(1): 33–74.
6. Hoos, F. & Khan, M. (2023). New rules of the game or game changer? Three things to consider as you prepare for (mandatory) sustainability reporting, *The European Business Review*, May-June: 38-44.
7. Hoos, F. & Tavaréz, R. (2023). Think your company is too small to worry about ESG reporting? Beware, you might quickly find yourself out of business. I by IMD (magazine), March: 68-70.

6. Grading

The assessment will be based on the following elements:

1. Class participation (individual): 20%
Instructor moderated class discussions and individual work result presentations are key learning mechanisms. Hence, active class participation (sharing your ideas and discussing those of others) is mandatory. Each student's contribution is evaluated based on the following criteria:
 - Thoughtful questions and insights during lectures and discussions
 - Relevance and depth of comments (I value quality more than quantity).

- Ability to build on the comments of others and provide valuable feedback.
- Quality of responses to the instructor's questions.

2. Final paper (group assignment): 80%

You should submit a final paper of not more than 3-5 (high quality) pages (1.5 line space for text body; excluding tables, figures or appendices; the latter should be added to the 5-7 pages).

The final paper will be due on **May 31, 2026 at 23:00 (CET)** and uploaded on E-Learning by one group representative. You will get the chance to work on one specific company of your choice, critically analyze its sustainability strategy, and develop recommendations. The final report should include (but is not limited to) the following:

- Choose a company and describe the company context (= the industry and competitors) and the trends that are important for that industry/company
- Describe the company itself in detail, with a focus on its sustainability and reporting strategy (include research articles, figures, press articles, financials, etc.), i.e., anything that is relevant to develop recommendations on ESG/sustainability 4.0
- Develop customized recommendations for the company in terms of ESG/sustainability 4.0. This is the major part and can look like a consulting report for the company.

Evaluation criteria

- Rigor and depth of company analyses and description of context with appropriate data (20%)
- Quality of application of the tools and methods of the course (40%)
- Quality and appropriate customization of the recommendations to the chosen company (40%)

7. Faculty Biography



Florian Hoos is Professor of Sustainability and Accounting at IMD in Lausanne and was the Managing Director of the Enterprise for Society Center (E4S) from 2022-2026. Before joining IMD in June 2022, he served 10 years as faculty member at HEC Paris, where he directed the Master's in Sustainability and Social Innovation. He was also a visiting assistant professor at MIT Sloan School (20014-20015). Besides his work in academia, Florian accumulated 10 years' experience in leadership positions as founder, investor, and managing director with his own firms.

Besides being a professor at IMD, Florian also works as a strategy consultant and collaboration expert for startups and large corporations with his Switzerland-based firm. From 2017-2019, Florian held the position of the Director of the Centre for Entrepreneurship at Technical University Berlin

(TUB) where he led a team of 25 people and was in charge of TUB's startup incubation and technology transfer. He is also a certified radical collaboration trainer and certified in theme-centered interaction.

Florian was listed as one of the 40 best Business School Professors under 40 in the world by Poets & Quants and won the Best Professor "Prix Vernimmen" Award by BNP Paribas (award for the best HEC Paris professor) in 2014. He also received the "Best Teaching Style 2015" and "Best Professor Core Phase 2013" awards of the MBA program at HEC Paris and received the prize for the pedagogical innovation of the year 2016 from the HEC Paris Foundation. Florian teaches in all of IMD's programs (eMBA, MBA, MSc, etc.), including customized programs, which he also designs and facilitates as Academic Director. In addition, he is a pioneer of online education on coursera.com and other platforms where he created courses on sustainability and social entrepreneurship and change making since 2014.

Florian is an active researcher with publications in leading international scientific journals such as the *Nature Sustainability*, *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, *Journal of Business Ethics* and *Accounting and Business Research*. He is also a member of the editorial board of *Academy of Management Learning & Education* – the leading journal for management education.

Programme ILOs. At completion of the BMI EMBA, participants should be versed in the following:

Category	Description
Managerial Knowledge (MK) – MK1	Mastering core aspects of business knowledge (including ethics, responsibility, and sustainability) and being able to integrate them for operational and strategic decisions.
Managerial Knowledge (MK) - MK2	Evaluating the main trends (i.e., economic, political, sociological, cultural, climate and technological) that will impact the business environment at an international level and more specifically in EU.
Managerial Skills (MS) - MS1	Working effectively, efficiently, and collaboratively with others (e.g. demonstrating negotiating and networking know-how, communicating effectively both within and across national settings).
Managerial Skills (MS) - MS2	Building and leading teams, including in multicultural and/or remote settings, and inspiring team members to contribute meaningfully.
Managerial Skills (MS) - MS3	Strategic vision (e.g. selecting relevant information to shape business decisions and focusing on key drivers of company success).
Managerial Mindsets (MM) - MM1	Expanding the range of thinking patterns (e.g., thinking critically, adopting creative and innovative solutions, harnessing the power of continuous testing and learning).
Managerial Mindsets (MM) - MM2	Embracing and leveraging ERS (i.e., embracing diversity and inclusion, committing to sustainable development).

“High” signifies the highest intensity of contribution: there is a strong relationship between the course and the managerial knowledge/skills/mindsets ILO

“Intermediate” signifies moderate intensity of contribution: there is a moderate relationship between the course and the managerial knowledge/skills/mindsets ILO

“Low” signifies low level of contribution: there is a weak relationship between the course and the managerial knowledge/skills/Mindsets ILO. Note that a low level of contribution does mean there is some contribution.